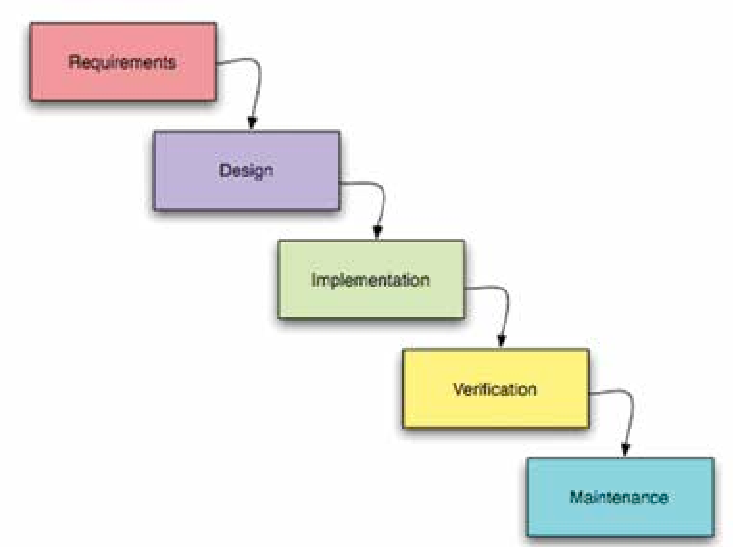

The Waterfall Model

ments, Design, Implementation, Verification and Maintenance. Although sometimes the different stages are also divided into: Analysis, Design, Implementation, Testing, Documentation and Execution, and Maintenance. (Notice that these are the basic steps of production that any methodology has to follow at some level.)

It is a planning oriented methodology as a lot of emphasis is placed on deadlines, time schedules, and budgets. Having all of this information beforehand is favourable for the client as it boosts the client's certainty. Moreover, in the case of an unfortunate incident such as a designer quitting the job, he can easily be replaced and the new designer can carry on where he left off, with everything being clearly laid out at the beginning of the project. However, waterfall development is a very rigid process, being so strictly sequential. Changes to the design can only be made at the design stage. Any mistakes or bad planning at the top end of the waterfall trickles down to the end and so there is basically no room for error, which is why this process is accompanied by a lot of formal documentation as well as strict and frequent audits and reviews. Moreover, the testing phase is near the end of the sequential process, and so the discovery of bugs (let's face it, no programmer is Godlike) often happens at the last moment, causing the additional expenditure of significant amounts of additional time, effort and